



“Fueling Global Trade, Connecting Continents”

DDS MARINE WEEKLY

MARITIME INTELLIGENCE

T A N K E R S | E N E R G Y | S T S | C O M P L I A N C E

Insight. Safety. Excellence.

ISSUE 007

11 SEPTEMBER 2026

Published by DDS Maritime Intelligence

A Research & Market Intelligence Publication of DDS Marine Energy Services

• Malaysia / Southeast Asia Focus — Prepared for Professional Circulation •



Executive Market Dashboard

Market snapshot: 9–11 September 2026 | Public market sources, official statements and DDS Marine market intelligence

BRENT CRUDE US\$107.63/bbl ▲ US\$6.42 d/d; crossed US\$100 on 9 Sep	WTI CRUDE US\$103.70/bbl ▲ US\$6.75 d/d	FUJAIRAH VLSFO US\$924.50/mt ▲ US\$37.50 d/d; US\$67 above Singapore
DIRTY TANKER TONE VERY FIRM ▲ Gulf-linked risk premium	CLEAN TANKER TONE VERY FIRM ▲ Pacific and Gulf strength	VLCC MARKET TONE EXCEPTIONALLY FIRM ▲ constrained willing tonnage

DDS VIEW — The tanker war has become a broader assault on merchant shipping. Iran states it attacked ten vessels near the Strait in what Reuters described as the largest declared wave of shipping attacks by either side since the war began; UKMTO reported several merchant vessels hit by disabling fire overnight in the northern Gulf and Gulf of Oman. This followed US strikes on five Iranian crude carriers on 8 September and three more on 5 September. Brent moved above US\$100 on 9 September and closed at US\$107.63 on 10 September. Freight conditions have strengthened sharply, particularly on Gulf-linked tanker trades, and Pacific product tanker markets continue to outperform Atlantic MR trading. Fujairah VLSFO now carries a substantial premium to Singapore, reinforcing the commercial importance of Southeast Asian bunkering and routing flexibility.

This Week at a Glance

- **Merchant shipping risk:** Iran claims attacks on ten vessels near Hormuz; UKMTO reports multiple merchant vessels hit by disabling fire; the tanker **NEW ANDROS**, carrying about 2m bbl of Iraqi fuel oil, caught fire.
- **US strikes:** CENTCOM reported strikes on five Iranian crude carriers on 8 Sep (*Kaviz, Charminar, Horizon 1, Riesco, Derya*), following three tanker strikes on 5 Sep; Iran struck Jordan's al-Azraq airbase in response.
- **Oil above US\$100:** Brent US\$107.63/bbl and WTI US\$103.70/bbl on 10 Sep as regional security risk intensified.
- **Freight:** Gulf-linked dirty and clean tanker markets strengthened sharply; Pacific product tanker markets continue to outperform Atlantic MR trading.
- **Red Sea:** Reported Houthi control of Mocha raises risk around the Bab el-Mandeb alternative corridor.



CEO Market Commentary

Capt. Dinesh Naidu KC — Founder & Chairman, DDS Marine Group

“When both chokepoints are contested at once, the corridor you can still count on stops being a convenience and becomes the business.”

Three weeks ago in Issue 005 I wrote that a quieter week was not the same as a settled one. I did not expect to be proved right this quickly or this comprehensively. What was a tanker war between two states has become, in the space of a week, a broader assault on merchant shipping. Iran says it attacked ten vessels. UKMTO logged several hit by disabling fire in a single night. A tanker carrying two million barrels of Iraqi fuel oil is on fire. These are not military targets in any meaningful sense. They are commercial ships with commercial crews.

Freight conditions this week are extraordinary, but they should not be mistaken for a healthy market. Dirty and clean tanker earnings have strengthened sharply, particularly on Middle East Gulf-linked trades. The market is pricing fewer willing ships, war-risk exposure, longer voyages and more difficult insurance discussions. High rates earned in these conditions are compensation for danger, not evidence of prosperity.

The clearest commercial signal is the widening bunker spread. In Issue 005, Fujairah VLSFO carried only a modest premium to Singapore. This week Fujairah is US\$67/mt above Singapore at US\$924.50/mt. The Gulf bunkering hub has become materially more expensive while Singapore remains comparatively steady. Add the reported Houthi seizure of Mocha and both principal regional chokepoints are now under heightened pressure.

That is precisely why our own corridor matters more this quarter than it ever has. Tonnage, cargo and bunkering demand are being pushed toward Malacca and Singapore not because we are cheap but because we are predictable. Predictability is a standard we have to keep earning on every job — through screening that holds up, documentation that survives scrutiny, and STS execution that no counterparty or underwriter can question. My instruction is unchanged and now more urgent: no Hormuz-linked nomination without owner-level authorisation and current-week war-risk confirmation, and no STS counterparty accepted without a full blacklist and transit-history check.

Capt. Dinesh Naidu KC

Founder & Chairman, DDS Marine Group

Publication Principle — Independent operational commentary based on publicly available market information, official statements, reputable wire and trade reporting (Reuters, Al Jazeera, UKMTO/CENTCOM statements, gCaptain, Hellenic Shipping News), public route descriptions and market-reported fixtures circulated to DDS Marine. Vessel names and incident details are published only where attributable to a named primary source.



This Week in Review

The week's principal developments, 5–11 September 2026

9–10 SEPTEMBER · REUTERS / UKMTO

Iran claims attacks on ten vessels near Hormuz

Iran stated it attacked ten vessels near the Strait of Hormuz, described by Reuters as the largest declared wave of tit-for-tat shipping attacks by either side since the war began. UKMTO reported several merchant vessels in the northern Gulf and Gulf of Oman hit by disabling fire overnight, and could not confirm casualties or environmental impact. A vessel was sighted listing at anchor 24nm from Port Rashid, UAE, possibly taking on water after a projectile strike, and a cargo ship was struck approximately 28nm southeast of al-Faw, Iraq. The Panama-flagged, Greek-owned tanker **NEW ANDROS**, carrying about two million barrels of Iraqi fuel oil under charter to the Iraqi Oil Tankers Company, caught fire.

8 SEPTEMBER · CENTCOM

US strikes five Iranian crude carriers

US Central Command struck five Iranian crude carriers late on 8 September: the *Kaviz*, *Charminar*, *Horizon 1* and *Riesco* in the Gulf of Oman, and the *Derya* near Kharg Island. Iran responded with an attack on Jordan's al-Azraq airbase. The strikes followed three Iranian tankers hit on 5 September, which in turn followed Iranian ballistic missile launches toward a US aircraft carrier and a destroyer operating near the Strait.

SEPTEMBER · AL JAZEERA / MARINETRAFFIC

An environmental tinderbox: 42 tankers waiting, 18 laden

MarineTraffic data showed 42 tankers waiting to transit the Strait as of Monday, 18 of them carrying oil, with a combined estimated capacity of roughly 1.76 million cubic metres — about 11.1 million barrels, or close to 11% of daily world oil demand. Analysts warn that a major tanker strike or sinking could release millions of litres into the Gulf, contaminating coastlines, fisheries and fragile marine ecosystems. The half-sunken tanker *Caroline Bezenji* is already cited as a live example of the risk.

SEPTEMBER · gCAPTAIN / BBC / HELLENIC SHIPPING NEWS

Houthi reported to have seized the port of Mocha

Houthi forces are reported to have seized the strategic Red Sea port of Mocha, tightening their proximity to the Bab el-Mandeb chokepoint and raising the operational risk profile for vessels transiting between the Indian Ocean and the Red Sea. Whether the advance materially closes Bab el-Mandeb to commercial traffic remains an open question, but it removes much of the comfort that the Red Sea routing offered as an alternative to Hormuz.

SEPTEMBER · SHIP & BUNKER / CENTCOM

US says Hormuz mines cleared; independent counts still thin

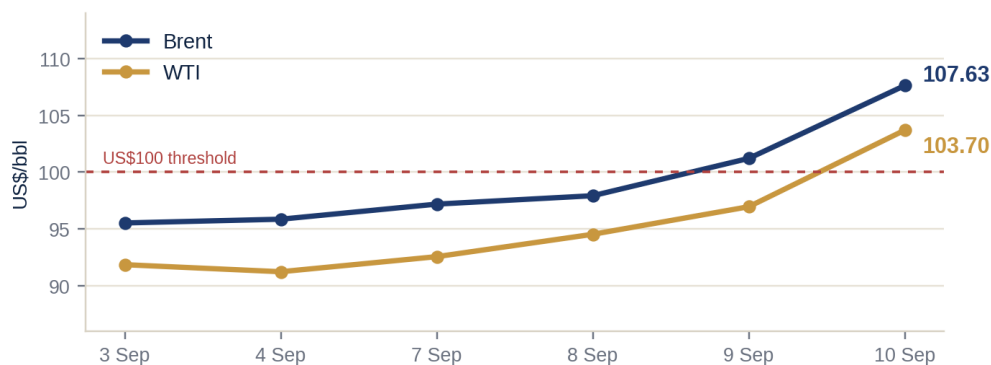
Admiral Brad Cooper said US forces have cleared Iranian sea mines from Strait of Hormuz shipping lanes and assisted more than 1,500 ships transiting in recent months. Independent transit counts remain far below pre-crisis norms: PortWatch's most recent published day (6 September) recorded six transits against a pre-crisis baseline of about 85 per day. As in Issue 006, we note the gap between official and independently tracked figures without resolving it.



Global Oil Market

Prices and the week's directional move, per Ship & Bunker daily series

Indicator	Latest	Reading
Brent crude	US\$107.63/bbl	10 Sep close, +US\$6.42 on the day; crossed US\$100 on 9 Sep and has not looked back.
WTI crude	US\$103.70/bbl	10 Sep close, +US\$6.75 on the day — the sharpest single-session move in our series.
Brent 3–10 Sep range	US\$95.52–107.63/bbl	A gain of roughly 12.7% across six sessions.
Move since Issue 006	+US\$12.77/bbl	Brent has risen from US\$94.86 at our last issue.



Brent and WTI daily close, 3–10 September 2026. Source: Ship & Bunker daily oil price series.

Market Interpretation

Crude has repriced decisively. The move accelerated on 9 September, when Brent broke US\$100 for the first time in our reporting series, and again on 10 September with a US\$6.42 single-session gain. The immediate drivers are the widening attacks on merchant shipping and the loss of confidence in any near-term restoration of normal Hormuz flows.

What distinguishes this from earlier moves in Issues 004 to 006 is breadth. Previously the rally was concentrated in crude while product and freight markets moved unevenly. This week crude, clean freight, dirty freight and bunkers have all moved sharply in the same direction at the same time — a pattern more consistent with a systemic risk repricing than with a supply headline.

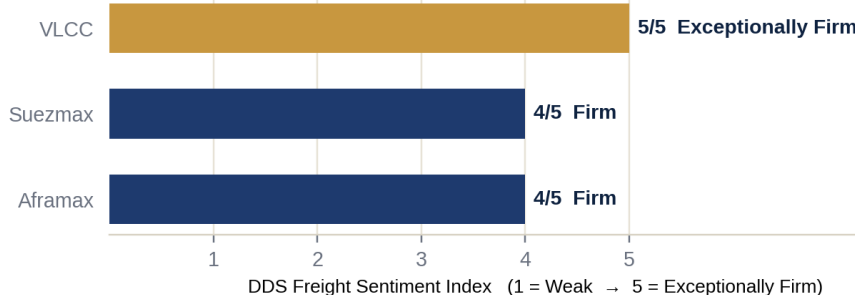
DDS BASE CASE — With merchant shipping now being attacked directly and both regional chokepoints contested, we see Brent holding above US\$100 while the current pattern persists, with upside toward US\$115–120 on any confirmed sinking, major spill, or strike on a loading terminal. A return below US\$95 requires a verified ceasefire, for which there is currently no indication.

Commercial effect on shipping: Every voyage estimate built before 8 September is now stale on at least three lines — fuel, war risk and expected voyage duration. Re-run them in full rather than adjusting the bunker figure alone.



Crude Tanker Market

VLCC, Suezmax and Aframax — DDS directional assessment, week ending 11 September 2026



DDS Freight Sentiment Index — DDS Marine's own analytical assessment. Not a third-party benchmark.

Segment	DDS Market Tone	Trend	Primary Driver
VLCC	5 / 5 — Exceptionally Firm	▲ ▲ Strong increase	ME Gulf risk premium and reduced willing tonnage
Suezmax	4 / 5 — Firm	▲ Increase	Gulf-linked demand outperforming Atlantic routes
Aframax	4 / 5 — Firm	▲ Increase	Mediterranean strength and regional repositioning

DDS Market Read

VLCC. Middle East Gulf VLCC business remains exceptionally firm. Owners are pricing war-risk exposure, transit uncertainty and the reduced pool of tonnage willing to enter contested waters. China and Southeast Asia-linked employment remains the main focus, while non-Gulf routes have moved less aggressively.

Suezmax. Sentiment is firm, with the strongest enquiry still attached to Gulf-linked voyages. Atlantic business remains active, but the premium is concentrated on trades where routing, insurance and owner approval have become part of the commercial negotiation.

Aframax. Firm, with Mediterranean and regional Asian employment providing support. Southeast Asia business remains comparatively orderly, while Gulf exposure continues to attract a clear risk premium.

DDS VIEW — *Crude tanker strength remains concentrated around Middle East Gulf exposure. The market is increasingly pricing vessel availability, war-risk costs and owners' willingness to transit contested waters rather than cargo demand alone.*

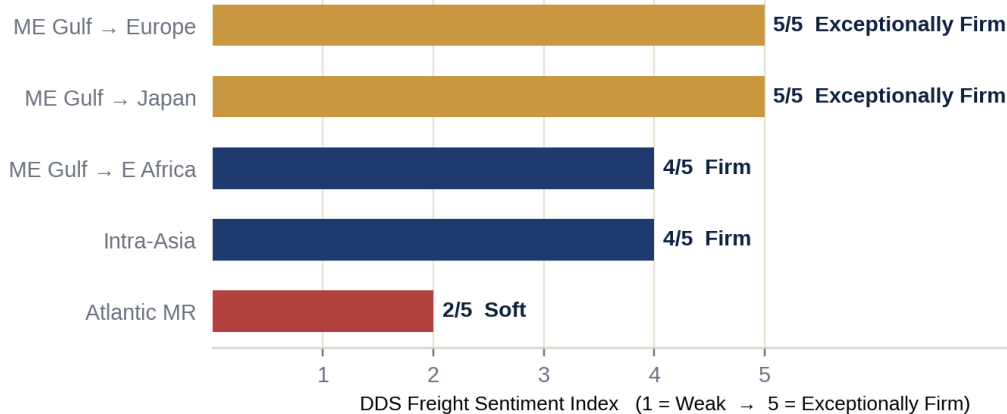
COMMERCIAL READING

- Re-run voyage economics wherever Gulf exposure is involved.
- Treat war-risk and routing flexibility as core commercial variables.
- Avoid assuming that headline strength represents broad-based cargo demand.

Source basis: public reporting, market-reported fixtures and DDS Marine operational/commercial intelligence. Directional only.

Clean & Product Tankers

DDS Clean Tanker Signal — directional assessment, week ending 11 September 2026



DDS Freight Sentiment Index — DDS Marine's own analytical assessment. Not a third-party benchmark.

Trade	DDS Score	Trend	DDS Assessment
ME Gulf → Europe	5 / 5	▲ ▲	Significant risk premium on Gulf-exposed voyages
ME Gulf → Japan	5 / 5	▲ ▲	Tight willing tonnage
ME Gulf → East Africa	4 / 5	▲	Regional disruption supporting rates
Intra-Asia	4 / 5	▲	Healthy Pacific demand
Atlantic MR	2 / 5	▼	Underperforming the Pacific market

DDS Market Read

Middle East Gulf. Clean tanker enquiry out of the Gulf remains very firm. LR2 and LR1 owners are demanding a material premium for voyages exposed to current transit and insurance risk, with UK-Continent and East Asia business particularly sensitive to vessel availability.

Pacific MR. Firm. Singapore, Korea, Japan and Australia-linked employment is benefiting from active intra-Asia demand without requiring the same contested-water exposure as Gulf-origin business.

Atlantic MR. Comparatively softer. The gap against Pacific employment has widened this week, making east-of-Suez positioning more attractive for suitable tonnage, subject to ballast economics and next employment.

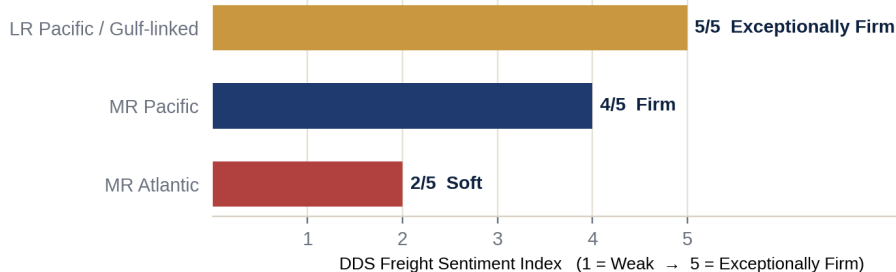
DDS VIEW — *Pacific product tanker markets continue to outperform the Atlantic, with intra-Asia employment providing attractive opportunities without the same level of contested-water exposure. For commercial decisions, separate Gulf-risk earnings from ordinary regional strength: both can produce a firm market, but the risk, insurance and voyage assumptions behind the number are very different.*

Source basis: public reporting, market-reported fixtures and DDS Marine operational/commercial intelligence. Directional only.



Pacific / Atlantic Product Tanker Split

DDS directional comparison — no third-party benchmark reproduced



DDS Freight Sentiment Index — DDS Marine's own analytical assessment. Not a third-party benchmark.

Market	DDS Tone	Trend	Commercial Reading
LR Pacific / Gulf-linked	5 / 5 — Very Firm	▲ ▲	Risk premium and constrained willing tonnage
MR Pacific	4 / 5 — Firm	▲	Intra-Asia demand and routing flexibility
MR Atlantic	2 / 5 — Soft	▼	Relative underperformance

Why the Split Matters Commercially

The Pacific advantage is not simply a freight story. It also reflects routing certainty, bunker planning and materially lower exposure to the present Gulf security situation. Intra-Asia CPP employment continues to support MR tonnage, with Singapore and North Asia the cleaner commercial positioning story this week, while Atlantic MR employment has not matched the strength seen east of Suez.

DDS VIEW — DDS would not chase a headline Gulf return without pricing the full voyage. For MR and LR tonnage, predictable intra-Asia employment can be commercially stronger once war-risk, delay and insurance exposure are taken into account. For tonnage capable of trading either basin, compare net voyage economics after war-risk, bunkers, positioning time and operational restrictions — not headline freight alone.

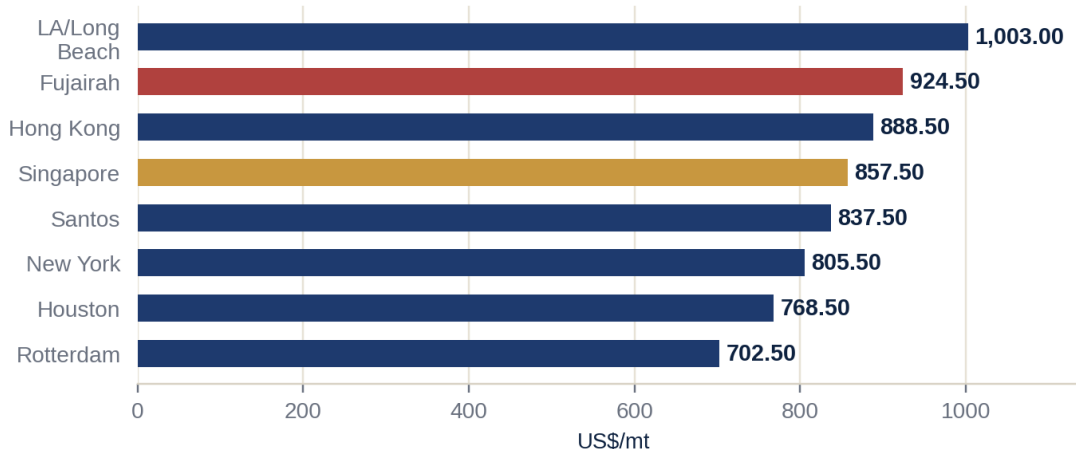
Source basis: public reporting, market-reported fixtures and DDS Marine operational/commercial intelligence. Directional only.



Bunker Market — Singapore & Global Benchmark

Current indications in US\$/mt, Ship & Bunker (shipandbunker.com), 10–11 September 2026

Grade	Singapore	Day Change	Fujairah	Day Change
VLSFO	US\$857.50	+US\$1.50	US\$924.50	+US\$37.50
MGO	US\$1,275.50	−US\$4.00	US\$1,509.00	+US\$32.00
IFO380	US\$681.00	+US\$13.50	US\$685.00	+US\$8.00



VLSFO by hub, US\$/mt. Singapore in gold, Fujairah in red. Source: Ship & Bunker, 10–11 September 2026.

The Fujairah Premium Has Widened

The single most commercially useful development in this issue is a spread. In Issue 005, Fujairah VLSFO (US\$788.00) carried a modest premium of about US\$7/mt over Singapore (US\$781.00). This week Fujairah has risen to **US\$924.50/mt (+US\$37.50 on the day)** while Singapore has moved only to US\$857.50 — widening the Fujairah premium to **US\$67/mt**. The MGO spread is starker still: Fujairah US\$1,509.00 against Singapore US\$1,275.50, a gap of US\$233.50/mt.

Only LA/Long Beach (US\$1,003.00) is now more expensive than Fujairah for VLSFO among the hubs we track. Rotterdam remains the cheapest at US\$702.50/mt. Regional averages tell the same story: APAC US\$921.00 (+US\$2.00) against EMEA US\$830.00 (+US\$4.00), with the Global 20 Ports Average at US\$851.00 (+US\$8.50).

Commercial implication: Fujairah currently carries a significant bunker premium versus Singapore, on top of war-risk and transit exposure. For any voyage with routing flexibility, the arithmetic increasingly favours lifting fuel in our corridor rather than at Fujairah. EU ETS compliance costs are broadly steady — EUA at €85.58, EUA-VLSFO equivalent US\$317.15/mt — and should continue to be stated explicitly in bunker and freight clauses for any EU-linked call.



Geopolitical & Route Risk

Both regional chokepoints contested simultaneously

Area	Current Signal	Commercial Consequence
Strait of Hormuz	Iran claims attacks on 10 vessels; UKMTO logs multiple merchant ships hit by disabling fire; US strikes 5 Iranian tankers 8 Sep.	Merchant shipping is now a direct target, not collateral. Treat all transits as owner-level decisions.
Transit volumes	PortWatch recorded 6 transits on 6 Sep vs ~85/day pre-crisis baseline; CENTCOM says 1,500+ ships assisted in recent months.	The official/tracked gap noted in Issue 006 persists; plan against tracked figures.
Bab el-Mandeb	Houthis reported to have seized the port of Mocha, tightening proximity to the chokepoint.	The Red Sea alternative is materially less attractive; fewer credible routing options remain.
Environmental	42 tankers waiting to transit, 18 laden with ~11.1m bbl combined; NEW ANDROS alight with ~2m bbl of fuel oil.	Spill risk is now a live commercial and reputational exposure, not a tail risk.

From Tanker War to General Assault

The qualitative change this week is that the conflict has stopped discriminating. Through Issues 004 to 006 the pattern was state-on-state: US strikes on Iranian tankers, Iranian strikes on US-linked vessels and warships. This week Iran declared attacks on ten vessels near the Strait, and UKMTO reported several merchant ships hit by disabling fire overnight across the northern Gulf and Gulf of Oman — including a vessel listing at anchor 24nm from Port Rashid and a cargo ship struck 28nm southeast of al-Faw. The **NEW ANDROS**, a Panama-flagged, Greek-owned tanker on charter to the Iraqi Oil Tankers Company, is alight with roughly two million barrels aboard. None of those profiles fits a military targeting rationale.

The Alternative Corridor Just Narrowed

Through previous issues, the Red Sea/Bab el-Mandeb routing has functioned as the imperfect but available alternative to Hormuz — the reason container majors were able to contemplate a Suez return in Issue 005. The reported Houthi seizure of Mocha changes that calculus. With both chokepoints contested at once, the practical consequence for our readership is that Malacca-routed and intra-Asia trade carries a scarcity value it has not had before.

DDS RISK LEVEL: CRITICAL (unchanged from Issue 006, but the character of the risk has changed). Merchant vessels with no state affiliation are now being struck. DDS recommends: no Hormuz-linked nomination without owner-level authorisation and current-week war-risk confirmation; a documented spill-response and salvage position before accepting any Gulf-linked cargo; and contingency routing assessed on the assumption that Bab el-Mandeb may not be available as a fallback.



Sanctions & Compliance Watch

Actionable controls for fixtures and STS operations

Developments — Week Ending 11 September 2026

Blacklist and STS contagion, standing from Issue 006: Iran's Persian Gulf Strait Authority blacklist of 45 tankers — including vessels linked to ADNOC Logistics & Services, Navig8 Tankers and Saudi Arabia's Bahri — remains in force, with the stated threat that any vessel conducting an STS transfer with a listed ship may itself be added. Nothing this week has softened that position, and the widening attacks make enforcement risk more credible rather than less.

Dark activity and identity risk: Windward reported an OFAC-sanctioned 281-metre container vessel that went dark on 25 March 2026 and remained off AIS for approximately 166 days, reappearing on 7 September and subsequently heading east toward the Gulf of Oman with Port Klang declared as its destination. Extended dark periods of this length, followed by a declared Malaysian destination, are precisely the profile our screening is designed to catch.

Direct relevance to our operations: a vessel emerging from a 166-day AIS gap and declaring a Port Klang destination is a live example of the risk sitting on our own doorstep. Any STS or bunkering counterparty presenting with a material recent dark period should be escalated to owner level before acceptance, regardless of how the paperwork reads.

Control	Minimum Action
Iran blacklist screening	Check the nominated vessel <i>and</i> its STS counterparties against the current 45-vessel list before fixing or accepting any STS job.
AIS dark-period review	Review full AIS history for gaps. Escalate any vessel with a dark period beyond a normal voyage profile, particularly where the declared destination is in our region.
War-risk confirmation	Obtain current-week war-risk quotes before nominating Gulf-linked tonnage; terms from before 8 September are stale.
Spill & salvage position	New this issue: confirm a documented spill-response and salvage position before accepting Gulf-linked cargo, given the elevated casualty rate.
Record preservation	Keep screenshots, screening evidence, approvals, emails, SOF and operational instructions in the job file.

Editorial & Verification Note: *DDS Marine Group publishes vessel names and designation detail only where attributable to a named primary source. Readers should verify any specific vessel against the current OFAC SDN list, the Iranian blacklist and their own screening provider before acting.*



Incident & Risk Watch

Confirmed and declared incidents, 5–11 September 2026

Vessel / Target	Detail	Source	Date
NEW ANDROS	Panama-flagged, Greek-owned tanker carrying ~2m bbl Iraqi fuel oil under charter to Iraqi Oil Tankers Company; caught fire.	Reuters / UKMTO	9–10 Sep
Unnamed vessel	Sighted listing at anchor 24nm from Port Rashid, UAE; possibly taking on water after strike by unknown projectile.	UKMTO	9–10 Sep
Unnamed cargo ship	Struck approximately 28nm southeast of al-Faw, Iraq.	UKMTO	9–10 Sep
Kaviz, Charminar, Horizon 1, Riesco	Iranian crude carriers struck by US forces in the Gulf of Oman.	CENTCOM	8 Sep
Derya	Iranian crude carrier struck by US forces near Kharg Island.	CENTCOM	8 Sep
Three Iranian tankers	Struck by US forces following Iranian ballistic missile launches toward a US carrier and destroyer near the Strait.	CENTCOM / Al Jazeera	5 Sep
Caroline Bezengi	Cited as damaged and half-sunken; referenced in reporting on Gulf spill risk.	Al Jazeera	Ongoing

Pattern assessment: Iran's declared wave of ten vessel attacks marks a shift from targeting state-affiliated shipping to targeting merchant traffic generally. UKMTO could not confirm casualties or environmental impact at time of reporting. The combination of an alight laden tanker, a vessel listing at anchor and 18 laden tankers waiting to transit makes a significant pollution event a realistic near-term scenario rather than a tail risk.

What We Are Watching

- Whether the **NEW ANDROS** fire is contained, and whether any pollution event follows from it or from the vessels struck on 8 September.
- Whether Iran's declared ten-vessel wave is repeated, or proves to be a one-off escalation.
- Whether the reported Houthi control of Mocha translates into interference with Bab el-Mandeb transits.
- P&I and war-risk underwriter response to merchant vessels being targeted without state affiliation.
- Whether the 42-tanker queue at the Strait begins to clear, or grows further.

Southeast Asia & STS Operations

Malaysia · Singapore · Indonesia · Thailand · Vietnam — the Malacca-to-Pengerang corridor

With both Hormuz and Bab el-Mandeb contested simultaneously, our corridor is becoming increasingly important. Three points from this issue make the case without any need for advocacy: Pacific product tanker markets continue to outperform Atlantic MR trading; Singapore VLSFO sits US\$67/mt below Fujairah, with the spread widening materially; and Gulf-to-Singapore crude employment remains among the strongest business on the board.

Market	Why It Matters This Week
Malaysia	Port Klang, Malacca, Muar, Linggi and the Johor STS/bunkering corridor. A sanctioned vessel emerging from a 166-day dark period declared Port Klang as destination — screening discipline is being tested directly.
Singapore	VLSFO at US\$857.50/mt against Fujairah US\$924.50 — a US\$67/mt advantage, and US\$233.50/mt on MGO. Bunkering demand should follow.
Indonesia	Batam and Karimun remain active in STS and bunkering; outer port limits require continued enhanced due diligence.
Thailand	Gulf of Thailand distribution continues to benefit from trade diversion as a secondary regional routing option.
Vietnam	Intra-Asia CPP demand firm, supporting Pacific product tanker employment.

STS & Marine-Services Operating Standard

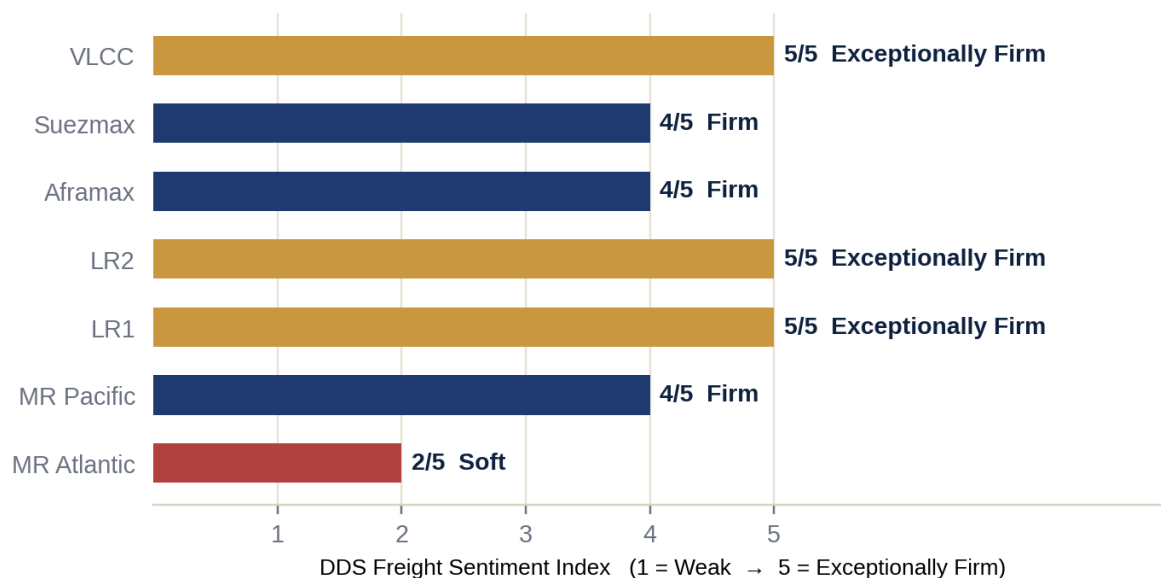
Operational Pillar	DDS Standard
Planning	Job-specific JPO, risk assessment, mooring plan, weather limits, communications plan and emergency response.
Vessel suitability	Compatibility review covering freeboard, manifold, fenders, hoses, mooring arrangement, vetting and cargo system.
Counterparty & identity	IMO verification; beneficial ownership; full AIS dark-period review; cargo-origin documentary chain; Iranian blacklist check on principals <i>and</i> STS counterparties.
Documentation	Accurate NOR, SOF, checklists, pumping records, delay evidence, photographs and final operation report.

DDS VIEW — *DDS expects increased tonnage and cargo interest in this corridor if current disruptions persist, and some of it will carry histories that will not survive scrutiny. The commercial opportunity and the compliance exposure are the same shipment. Everything therefore rests on screening that holds up after the fact — which is the one part of this entire situation we actually control.*



DDS Freight Market Monitor

Independent DDS market sentiment — 1 = Weak | 2 = Soft | 3 = Balanced | 4 = Firm | 5 = Exceptionally Firm



DDS Freight Sentiment Index, 11 September 2026 — DDS Marine's own analytical assessment. Not a third-party benchmark.

Market	DDS Score	Trend	DDS Market Read
VLCC	5 / 5	▲ ▲	Middle East Gulf exposure the main driver; willing tonnage limited and owner approval increasingly fixture-specific.
Suezmax	4 / 5	▲	Gulf-linked business outperforming the Atlantic; insurance and routing central to negotiations.
Aframax	4 / 5	▲	Mediterranean and East-of-Suez activity supported, with a premium attached to Gulf transit.
LR2	5 / 5	▲ ▲	Gulf-origin long-haul commanding a material risk premium.
LR1	5 / 5	▲	Firm alongside LR2 on Gulf-linked employment.
MR Pacific	4 / 5	▲	Intra-Asia product trades showing healthy demand and comparatively cleaner execution.
MR Atlantic	2 / 5	▼	Underperforming Pacific employment this week.

DDS MARKET SIGNAL — Middle East Gulf-linked tanker markets remain the strongest part of the board, while Pacific clean-product employment continues to outperform Atlantic MR trading. Risk, availability and routing flexibility remain the principal freight drivers.

DDS Gas & Regional Monitor

Market	DDS Tone	Trend	What DDS Is Watching
LPG	3 / 5 — Balanced	▬ Flat	Gulf LPG is difficult to read where regular benchmark assessment is thin; US Gulf export business provides the clearer signal.
LNG	3 / 5 — Balanced/Firm	▲	Steady to firmer on selected long-haul employment; vessel specification and delivery position matter more than headline averages.
Intra-Asia CPP	4 / 5 — Firm	▲	Regional product movement supportive.
Singapore-linked clean	4 / 5 — Firm	▲	Bunker and routing advantage supports corridor interest.

Publication note: DDS scores are independent analytical opinions prepared for market intelligence purposes. They are not third-party benchmarks and should not be treated as executable freight quotations.



Period / Time-Charter Market

Market-reported period fixtures, week ending 11 September 2026 — subject to confirmation

Vessel	Size / Built	Rate	Duration	Delivery	Charterer
VLCC					
New Odyssey	318k / 2016 SWS	US\$80,000/day	36 months	Pacific	ADNOC
SUEZMAX					
Barcelona Spirit	158k / 2011 Samsung	US\$100,000/day	12 months	Rotterdam	Mercuria
Segway	156k / 2025 New Times	US\$100,000/day	12 months	UK-Cont	Exxon (DF-LNG)
AFRAMAX / LR2					
Lyric Magnolia	110k / 2016 Sungdong	US\$57,000/day	9 months	DC Fujairah	ADMIC-ADNOC
Passionate Warrior	115k / 2026 Changhong	US\$75,000/day	12 months	Ex yard	Trafigura
MR-2 CHEMICAL					
CL Marguerite Duras	50k / 2023 New Times	US\$26,000/day	24 months	—	Shell (IMO-2)
CL George Eliot	50k / 2023 New Times	US\$26,000/day	24 months	—	Shell (IMO-2)
CL Agathe Christie	50k / 2023 New Times	US\$26,000/day	24 months	—	Shell (IMO-2)
CL Pearl Buck	50k / 2023 New Times	US\$26,000/day	24 months	—	Shell (IMO-2)
MR-2					
Grand Winner 2	50k / 2021 HD-Vinashin	US\$31,600/day	11–14 months	Singapore	Exxon (on subs)
Esteem Endeavour	50k / 2020 HD Mipo	US\$26,500/day	24 months	Sing–Japan	CNR (on subs)
Nord Minami	51k / 2021 Minaminippon	US\$24,000/day	60 months	Med	NYK
Largo Atom	50k / 2025 GSI	US\$25,000/day	36 months	Worldwide	Weco Tankers

Publication note: Named period fixtures and rates above are **market reported and subject to confirmation** unless independently confirmed by the contracting parties.

DDS VIEW — period market: *Period business shows where serious charterers will commit capital beyond a short spot spike. Suezmax has repriced hard, with 12-month deals reported around US\$100,000/day; one major took four chemical MRs on 24-month charters and another fixed a full five years. Commitments of that length suggest this is not being treated as a spike to be waited out.*



Seven-Day Outlook: 12 – 18 September 2026

12 – 18 September 2026

Market	Base Case	Upside Risk	Downside Risk
Crude oil	Brent holds above US\$100 while attacks on merchant shipping continue.	US\$115–120 on a confirmed sinking, major spill or terminal strike.	Below US\$95 only on a verified ceasefire; no current indication.
VLCC	Very firm; Gulf-linked employment holds near the strongest levels we have assessed.	Further owner withdrawal tightening the willing pool.	Rapid de-escalation returning withheld tonnage to the corridor.
Clean / products	Gulf routes stay elevated; Pacific employment holds its advantage over the Atlantic.	Further Gulf loading disruption extending the clean-tanker surge.	Atlantic recovery narrowing the Pacific/Atlantic gap.
Bunkers	Fujairah premium over Singapore persists while Gulf supply risk is elevated.	Wider premium if Gulf bunkering is further disrupted.	Premium narrows if crude reverses or Gulf supply normalises.
Southeast Asia	Corridor importance rises with both chokepoints contested; STS and bunkering demand grows.	Further redirected tonnage and cargo into the corridor.	A credible ceasefire reducing the diversion premium.

Watch List

- Whether the **NEW ANDROS** fire results in a pollution event, and how P&I and war-risk markets respond if it does.
- Whether Iran repeats a mass-attack wave on merchant shipping, or 9–10 September proves a ceiling.
- Whether Gulf LPG benchmark assessment returns to normal depth, or remains thin.
- Whether the Fujairah–Singapore VLSFO spread widens beyond US\$67/mt.
- Whether reported Houthi control of Mocha translates into interference with Bab el-Mandeb transits.
- Whether the 42-tanker queue at the Strait clears or grows.

DDS CONCLUSION — Issue 006 recorded a credibility gap between what officials described and what trackers could see. Issue 007 records something harder to dispute: merchant ships are being hit, a laden tanker is on fire, Brent is above US\$107, and freight conditions have strengthened sharply across every segment we assess. The defining feature of this week is not the height of the rates but the narrowing of the options — with Hormuz contested and Bab el-Mandeb newly compromised, there are fewer places left to route cargo safely. That makes the reliability of our own corridor the most valuable asset this company has, and the one we can least afford to be careless with.



Methodology, Sources & Disclaimer

ISSUE 007

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Source	Information Used
Ship & Bunker (shipandbunker.com), 10–11 Sep 2026	VLSFO, MGO and IFO380 indications across eight hubs; regional and global averages; EUA compliance costs; Brent/WTI daily close series 3–10 Sep.
Reuters / UKMTO, 9–10 Sep 2026	Iran's declared attacks on ten vessels; merchant vessels hit by disabling fire; the NEW ANDROS fire; vessel listing near Port Rashid; cargo ship struck off al-Faw.
US Central Command, 5 & 8 Sep 2026	Strikes on five Iranian crude carriers (<i>Kaviz</i> , <i>Charminar</i> , <i>Horizon 1</i> , <i>Riesco</i> , <i>Derya</i>) and three tankers on 5 Sep; mine-clearance and transit-assistance statements.
Al Jazeera, 6 & 9 Sep 2026	Tanker-war analysis; MarineTraffic queue data (42 tankers waiting, 18 laden, ~11.1m bbl); Gulf spill-risk assessment.
gCaptain / BBC / Hellenic Shipping News	Reported Houthi seizure of the port of Mocha and Bab el-Mandeb implications.
Windward, 7–8 Sep 2026	OFAC-sanctioned container vessel returning to AIS after ~166 days dark, declaring Port Klang destination.
Market fixture reports circulated to DDS Marine, 9 Sep 2026	VLCC, Suezmax, Aframax/LR2 and MR period fixtures — market reported and subject to confirmation.
DDS Marine market intelligence	Broker quotes, open tonnage, cargo enquiries and confirmed/public fixtures underpinning the DDS Freight Sentiment Index.

What's changed since Issue 006 (4 September 2026): The conflict has widened from state-affiliated shipping to merchant traffic generally. The US struck eight Iranian tankers across 5 and 8 September. Brent has risen from US\$94.86 to US\$107.63, crossing US\$100 on 9 September. Dirty and clean tanker markets both strengthened sharply, with DDS assessing VLCC and LR2 sentiment at 5/5. The Fujairah–Singapore VLSFO premium widened materially to US\$67/mt. Houthis are reported to have seized Mocha, compromising the Bab el-Mandeb alternative. Risk level remains CRITICAL.

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ISSUE 007 — 11 SEPTEMBER 2026 | Prepared for professional circulation | Malaysia / Southeast Asia focus